

19-turn track, winding through iconic landmarks like Napier Bridge and the Victoria War Memorial, saw thousands in attendance.

Indians in motorsports

It was yet another successful year for India in world motorsport, with several drivers and riders finishing on the podium and flying the flag high. Kush Maini, an Alpine Academy driver competing in his second F2 season, became the first Indian to win a sprint race, secure a pole position, and help his team (Invicta Racing) secure the Constructors' Championship.

Rally rider Aishwarya Pissay (**below**), the first Indian to win a world motorsport title (2019 FIM Bajas World Cup), had another solid year and claimed a record-breaking third World Cup medal. Johann Emmanuel scripted history by becoming the first Indian to win all three races in the 300 SSP category of the Qatar Superbike and Superstock Championship at the Lusail International Circuit in Qatar.

In the karting division, Atiq Mir powered through the field and won several laurels. She became the first female racer to win a race at the Rotax Challenge International Trophy at Le Mans and the first Indian to finish on the podium in the Mini U10 category in the history of the Champions of the Future Academy Program, an initiative supported by the F1 Academy.

IN 2025...

The 2025 Formula One caravan will be gearing up for fresh battles, with only 10 drivers staying with their respective teams, and five F2 graduates added to the mix. The F1 bandwagon will set off on another 24-race-long season, with Hamilton beginning a new journey with Ferrari and Lawson facing a tough challenge in Red Bull's second seat.

MotoGP has scheduled a record 22 rounds for the second successive year, with Hungary making its debut and Thailand hosting the opening round.

Martin, the new Aprilia rider, will be on a mission to defend his crown against Bagnaia, who will be joined by six-time champion Marc Marquez at Ducati Lenovo.

Among Indian motorsport athletes, Bengaluru-born Maini will drive for DAMS in his third F2 season, with eyes set on the top spot. Ace rider Pissay will compete in the upcoming Baja World Cup, aiming for a place in the prestigious Dakar Challenge.

The Indian motorsport events are expected to continue fostering talent through national championships, which have consistently identified and propelled skilled racers to the international stage.

